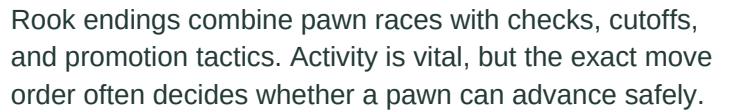


Rook-ending tactics

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on h6. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

42.Rh8# Mate: rook on h8 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on h6. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Rook on h8. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.